MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS • REGULATORY GOVERNANCE (MFS-GOV-09)

Conflict of Interest & Assessment Impartiality Policy

Identifying, declaring, mitigating, and reporting personal, professional, and assessment Conflicts of Interest across all regulated Functional Skills sittings.

Document Reference	MFS-GOV-09	**Effective Date**	11 November 2026
Quality & Centre Lead	Abdul (Head of Centre)	**Regulatory Alignment**	Ofqual Condition A4 (Conflicts of Interest) & Open Awards Centre Rules

1. Mandatory Duty to Identify & Declare Conflicts of Interest

Under Ofqual General Condition A4 and Open Awards Centre Recognition requirements, Master Functional Skills proactively identifies, records, and mitigates any actual, potential, or perceived Conflict of Interest (COI) that could compromise — or appear to compromise — the impartiality of assessment delivery, invigilation, marking, or Internal Quality Assurance (IQA).

- **Personal Relationship Conflict:** A tutor, assessor, invigilator, or IQA is related to, lives with, or has a close personal friendship or financial relationship with a candidate.
- **Dual-Role Assessment Conflict:** The tutor who prepared a candidate attempting to act as both Assessor and IQA, or invigilating an assessment where they have a vested financial bonus tied to pass rates.
- **Staff-as-Candidate Conflict:** Any member of staff or contractor enrolling for a qualification delivered through the centre.

2. Operational Segregation of Duties & Mitigation Controls

All staff complete a mandatory Conflict of Interest Declaration upon appointment, annually each November, and prior to every exam series:

Conflict Scenario	Mandatory Mitigation Control	Approval & Oversight
Staff Member / Tutor Knows Candidate Personally	Staff member is completely recused from invigilating, assessing, or quality-assuring that candidate; independent invigilator/assessor assigned	Logged in COI Register + declared to Awarding Body prior to sitting
Tutor Assessed Candidate's English SLC	Strict functional separation: a Tutor/Assessor can NEVER IQA their own candidate's SLC or Entry Level assessment; independent IQA signs off	100% enforced via IQA Sampling Matrix (MFS-GOV-10)

Remuneration & Pass-Rate Independence	Zero staff pay, contractor fees, or invigilator rates are ever linked to candidate pass percentages	Verified in all tutor & invigilator service agreements

3. Register of Interests & Escalation to Open Awards

Transparency with the Awarding Organisation is mandatory whenever a potential conflict involves regulated assessments:

- **Advance Written Notification to Awarding Body:** Any declared conflict involving a live assessment candidate or staff member is reported to Open Awards (or the relevant Awarding Organisation) in writing prior to the assessment sitting for formal approval of mitigation controls.
- **Audit Inspection Readiness:** The live Register of Conflicts of Interest is maintained by the Head of Centre (Abdul) and presented during every External Quality Assurance (EQA) and centre compliance review.

Document Control & Annual Governance Sign-Off

Approved By (Head of Centre & Quality Nominee):	Abdul — Master Functional Skills
Approval & Publication Date:	11 November 2026 (Version 2026.11)
Next Mandatory Annual Review Date:	11 November 2027 (or immediately upon Ofqual / Awarding Body update)